

Michael A. Melendez

Game Designer • Systems Designer • Technical Designer

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SUMMARY

Game Designer focused on systems, combat, and narrative structure. Blends a BS in Game & Simulation Programming with technical prototyping in Unity/C# and 10+ years of engineering experience. Designs modular systems, TCG mechanics, and branching narrative supported by clear GDD/TDD documentation. Currently developing a mobile gacha RPG from the ground up — solo concept, design, and implementation.

CORE SKILLS

Systems Design • Combat Design • TCG Mechanics • Progression & Balancing • Encounter Design • Narrative Systems • Unity • C# • C++ • GDScript • Godot 4 • Prototyping • Git • Worldbuilding • Branching Narrative • GDD/TDD Writing

GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

Triarchy: Houses of Mythos — Mobile Gacha RPG *2025–Present*

Sole Designer & Developer | Godot 4 | GDScript | Firebase | iOS/Android | In Development

- Sole designer and developer of a mobile gacha RPG for iOS/Android built in Godot 4; conceived and executed full game vision from initial concept through working prototype
- Designed 132 heroes across 11 tribes (Undead, Infernal, Angelic, Draconic, Egyptian, Norse, Futuristic, Gaia, Aquatic, Shadow, Fae), each with unique stats, ability kits, rarity tiers (Common/Rare/Epic/Legendary), class archetypes, and tribal synergy bonuses; 66 heroes slated for launch
- Authored a complete 57-page Master GDD covering turn-based auto-battle combat engine, energy & damage calculation systems, gacha pity system, equipment enhancement, tribal synergies, 5 status effect types, and type advantage matrix
- Designed full social infrastructure: Houses (guilds up to 30), 3-House Triarchy alliances with 165 unique alliance names derived from tribal compositions, and a 90-day seasonal reset system that dissolves alliances and resets territories to prevent meta stagnation
- Architected Firebase backend schema for real-time multiplayer including user data, server/house/triarchy structures, territory maps, 6-channel chat system, and server-side Cloud Functions for anti-cheat validation
- Implemented working prototype with functional turn-based combat state machine, hero database (132 heroes via JSON), cloud save, and gacha summoning with pity system in GDScript
- Designed complete monetization model: gacha shard packs, seasonal battle passes, cosmetics, and convenience items — all non-pay-to-win with F2P viable progression paths
- Seeking investment for professional art production (66-hero launch portfolio estimated at ~\$79K)

Champions of Rymora — Original Trading Card Game *2024–Present*

Systems Design • Game Design • Balancing

- Designed a complete TCG rules engine including resource systems, timing windows, zone interactions, and faction identities

- Authored full GDD/TDD documentation covering card types, abilities, turn structure, and edge-case rules
- Built a modular card database and balancing framework for scalable iteration

Unity Turn-Based Battle System — Modular Combat Framework 2024

Technical Design • Systems Design • Unity/C#

- Built a fully functional 2D turn-based combat system with modular architecture for reuse across RPG projects
- Implemented turn logic, ability systems, enemy AI, status effects, and party mechanics
- Designed data-driven configuration for rapid iteration and customization

Fangs of the Frost Wyrm — D&D 5e One-Shot + Solo CYOA Adaptation 2023

Narrative Design • Encounter Design • Branching Narrative

- Designed a 3–5 hour adventure featuring wilderness survival, environmental hazards, and multi-phase combat; authored full adventure module, companion guide, and playtest notes
- Converted the one-shot into a fully branching solo adventure with state tracking, multiple endings, and four dynamic archetypes with unique narrative and mechanical outcomes

Fal'shari — Warcraft Lore Bible 2022

Worldbuilding • Narrative Design

- Created an extensive lore bible integrating an original elven research collective into Warcraft's world with characters, factions, locations, and thematic pillars aligned with existing canon

Crestfall — Horror Novel (In Progress) 2023–Present

Narrative Design

- Writing a character-driven supernatural horror novel with psychological tension and ensemble storytelling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Software Engineer 2012–Present

Self-Employed / Voltex / Accenture / 5th Planet Games / Grapevine MSP

- Built production-ready systems in C++, C#, JavaScript, Python, and GDScript with a focus on clarity and modularity
- Collaborated with cross-disciplinary teams to implement features aligned with user experience goals
- Created tools and internal systems that improved workflow efficiency and iteration speed
- Applied engineering expertise to support gameplay prototyping, data structures, and system scalability

EDUCATION

BS in Game & Simulation Programming — DeVry University, Long Beach, CA

Capstone: Custom C++ game engine, GDD/TDD authorship, systems design specialization

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Engines / Languages: Godot 4, GDScript, Unity, C#, C++, Python, JavaScript, Java

Design Tools: Git, VS Code, Notion, Jira

Backend / Data: Firebase (Realtime DB, Cloud Functions), JSON, ScriptableObjects

Formats: GDD, TDD, Adventure Modules, Lore Bibles, Card Databases